both scenarios is that of determining who gets to talk (that is, transmit into the channel) and when. As humans, we've evolved an elaborate set of protocols for sharing the broadcast channel:

"Give everyone a chance to speak."
"Don't speak until you are spoken to."
"Don't monopolize the conversation."
"Raise your hand if you have a question."
"Don't interrupt when someone is speaking."
"Don't fall asleep when someone is talking."

Computer networks similarly have protocols—so-called **multiple access protocols**—by which nodes regulate their transmission into the shared broadcast channel. As shown in Figure 6.8, multiple access protocols are needed in a wide variety of network settings, including both wired and wireless access networks, and satellite networks. Although technically each node accesses the broadcast channel through its adapter, in this section, we will refer to the *node* as the sending and

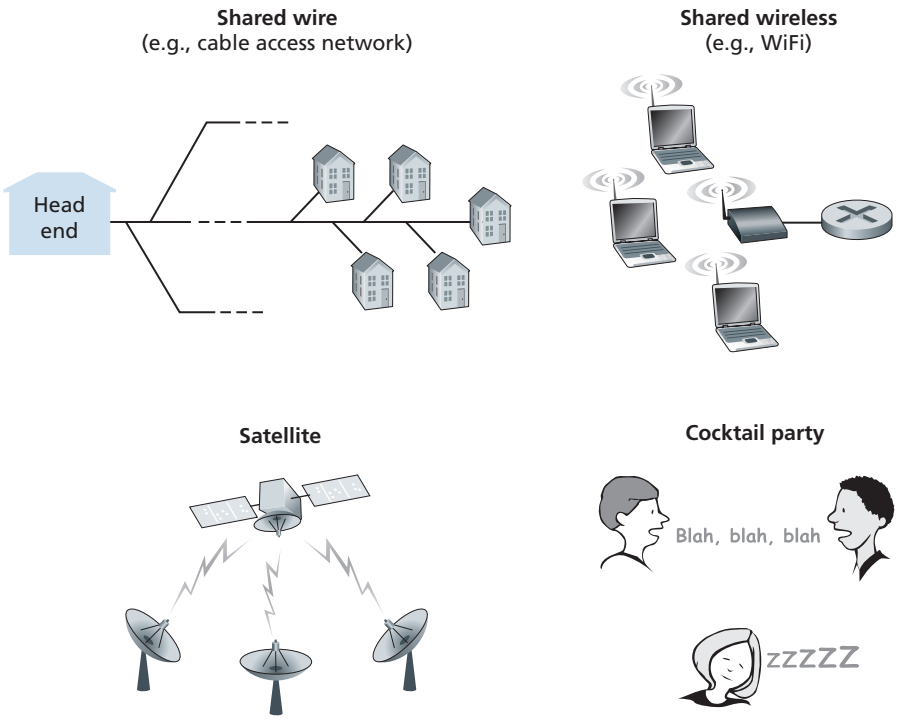

Figure 6.8 ♦ Various multiple access channels